15 Side Jobs for Nurses: Best Nurse Side Hustles to Earn Extra Income

Nursing is a demanding career, but it can also come with something many traditional jobs do not offer: blocks of time away from work. Depending on the hospital, clinic, or healthcare organization, nurses may work long shifts followed by several days away from their regular schedule.

That flexibility creates an opportunity to build additional income without necessarily taking another conventional part-time job.

The right side hustle for nurses can use the skills, education, license, and clinical experience you already have. Some opportunities involve picking up extra nursing shifts, while others allow you to work remotely, teach students, write health content, or provide specialized professional services.



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In 2026, nurses have more options than simply working overtime. You can choose a side job that pays immediately, build a flexible business over time, or combine an active income source with a lower-effort option.

This guide covers practical side hustles for nurses, including what each option involves, how to get started, who it may suit, and what to consider before committing your time.

Why Side Hustles for Nurses Make Sense

Nurses already possess valuable skills that other industries pay to access.

Depending on your role and qualifications, you may have experience with:

- Patient communication
- Clinical documentation
- Medical terminology
- Emergency response
- Health education
- Medication safety

- Patient assessment
- Care coordination
- Medical research
- Clinical technology
- Training and mentoring

Instead of learning an entirely new profession, a nursing side hustle can build on those existing abilities.

Your schedule can also be an advantage.

A nurse who works three 12-hour shifts may have several consecutive days available for another activity. That makes appointment-based, remote, freelance, and per-diem work easier to organize than a side job requiring fixed evening hours every day.

However, more working hours are not automatically better.

Sleep, recovery, family responsibilities, employer policies, professional licensing, and taxes all matter when choosing extra income for nurses.

12 Side Hustles for Nurses in 2026

1. Per Diem and PRN Nursing Shifts

Picking up occasional per diem or PRN shifts is one of the most direct ways for a nurse to earn additional money.

Instead of committing to a permanent second position, you can accept individual shifts when your schedule allows.

Staffing platforms and healthcare facilities may offer openings in hospitals, nursing homes, outpatient facilities, rehabilitation centers, and other clinical environments.

For nurses who already have an active license, this option can have a relatively short learning curve because the work remains within their existing profession.

How it works

You create a profile with a staffing company or apply directly to facilities offering PRN work. Once approved, you can select available shifts that fit your schedule.

Before accepting a shift, consider:

- Patient-to-nurse ratios
- Facility type
- Unit orientation
- Required credentials
- Travel time
- Cancellation policies

- Hourly compensation

The attached source highlights per diem and PRN work as a major route for nurses seeking immediate additional income and notes that existing credentials can reduce the need for additional certification.

Best for: Nurses who want relatively fast, active income.

2. Telehealth Nurse Jobs

Telehealth has created another way for nurses to use their clinical knowledge without spending every working hour at a bedside.

Telehealth nurses may handle patient calls, symptom assessments, follow-up communication, care coordination, or other remote healthcare tasks, depending on the employer and role.

This can be particularly attractive for nurses who want a side job that does not require commuting to another facility.

What you may need

Requirements vary by employer, but some positions may prefer:

- Active nursing license
- Clinical experience
- Strong communication skills
- Computer literacy
- Reliable internet
- Experience with triage or care coordination

Multi-state licensure can also be useful for some remote healthcare positions, although requirements depend on the role and location.

The source article describes telehealth triage as a higher-paying nursing side-work category and emphasizes that experience and location can affect compensation.

Best for: Nurses who prefer remote work and clinical decision-making.

3. Medical Surveys for Nurses

Paid medical surveys can provide a lower-commitment way to monetize professional knowledge.

Healthcare researchers, pharmaceutical companies, medical organizations, and research firms may seek opinions from healthcare professionals.

Depending on the survey, you could be asked about:

- Clinical products
- Medical technology
- Treatment experiences
- Healthcare workflows

- Professional preferences
- Industry trends

The biggest advantage is flexibility.

A survey may take only a few minutes, meaning it can potentially be completed during genuinely free personal time rather than requiring another full shift.

However, surveys should generally be viewed as supplemental income rather than a replacement for a nursing paycheck.

The source specifically includes medical survey platforms and describes them as one of the lowest-effort options for nurses.

Best for: Nurses who want occasional, low-commitment extra income.

4. Seasonal Vaccine Clinic Work

Seasonal vaccination clinics can provide short-term opportunities for nurses.

Flu clinics, workplace health programs, pharmacies, schools, and community organizations may need qualified healthcare workers during periods of increased vaccination demand.

One advantage is that these positions may involve shorter shifts than a typical hospital schedule.

For a nurse with limited availability, a two- or four-hour clinic assignment can sometimes be easier to fit into a day off than another 12-hour shift.

Why it can work well

Seasonal work is predictable enough to plan around.

You can begin looking for opportunities before demand peaks and reserve selected days for clinic work.

Always verify the credentials and scope-of-practice requirements applicable to your location and the specific position.

The source article identifies seasonal vaccine clinic work as an option with shorter shifts and a schedule that can suit nurses looking for occasional additional work.

Best for: Nurses who want short-term or seasonal shifts.

5. Clinical Research Nursing

Clinical research can be an interesting alternative to traditional bedside work.

Research nurses may work with clinical trials, study participants, documentation, laboratory procedures, protocols, and research teams.

The work can be attractive to nurses who enjoy structured processes and detailed documentation.

A research position may involve:

- Participant screening
- Study visits

- Data collection
- Clinical documentation
- Protocol compliance
- Patient education
- Communication with research teams

Because clinical trials often follow predefined schedules, the work may be more predictable than some traditional clinical environments.

The source article includes per-diem clinical research nursing among its options and notes that these positions can offer relatively predictable scheduling.

Best for: Nurses interested in research and structured clinical work.

6. Legal Nurse Consulting

Legal nurse consulting can turn clinical experience into a specialized professional service.

A legal nurse consultant may help attorneys understand medical records and healthcare-related information.

Potential work can include:

- Reviewing medical records
- Creating medical timelines
- Identifying relevant documentation
- Explaining clinical terminology
- Researching medical issues
- Supporting case preparation

This is not normally a quick-start side hustle.

Building credibility, understanding the legal environment, finding clients, and developing professional relationships can take considerable time.

However, nurses with strong clinical documentation and analytical skills may find this area appealing.

The attached source describes legal nurse consulting as a higher-ceiling option but also emphasizes that establishing paid work can take months.

How to approach it

Start by learning what legal nurse consultants actually do and what services you can legitimately provide based on your qualifications.

You can then develop a professional profile, create appropriate samples, network with legal professionals, and look for legitimate opportunities.

Best for: Experienced nurses interested in medical-legal work.

7. CPR, BLS and ACLS Instruction

Teaching healthcare-related courses can turn your existing knowledge into a repeatable side income stream.

Depending on your qualifications and the training organization, you may be able to teach courses such as:

- CPR
- BLS
- ACLS
- First aid
- Other approved safety courses

Classes can often be scheduled around evenings, weekends, or selected days off.

The business model can also be different from ordinary hourly employment. Some instructors receive compensation per class rather than simply tracking an hourly wage.

Building recurring clients

Instead of relying only on individual students, look for organizations that need regular training.

Potential customers include:

- Clinics
- Daycare centers
- Gyms
- Small businesses
- Schools
- Healthcare organizations

The source notes that instructor work can provide recurring opportunities because healthcare organizations periodically require certification and recertification.

Best for: Nurses who enjoy teaching and public interaction.

8. NCLEX and Nursing Student Tutoring

If you are good at explaining difficult concepts, tutoring can become one of the simplest side hustles for nurses to start.

You can help nursing students understand topics they are already studying rather than learning a completely new subject yourself.

Possible tutoring subjects include:

- Anatomy and physiology
- Pharmacology

- Dosage calculations
- Nursing fundamentals
- Care planning
- Test-taking strategies
- NCLEX preparation

You can offer sessions online or locally.

Online tutoring platforms can help you find students, while independent tutoring allows you to build your own client base.

The source article specifically identifies NCLEX and nursing-school tutoring as an option that can use knowledge nurses already possess.

How to get your first students

Start with a specific niche rather than advertising yourself as someone who teaches everything.

For example, you might specialize in dosage calculations or NCLEX preparation.

Referrals from current students can then become a valuable source of additional clients.

Best for: Nurses who enjoy teaching and explaining concepts.

9. Freelance Medical Writing

Nurses can also use their clinical knowledge to create health-related content.

Medical writers may work on:

- Patient education
- Healthcare websites
- Medical blogs
- Educational resources
- Health newsletters
- Training materials
- Healthcare marketing content

The ability to translate complicated medical information into understandable language is valuable.

You do not necessarily need to become a professional journalist. What matters is being able to research carefully, write clearly, follow editorial instructions, and avoid making unsupported medical claims.

The source article distinguishes beginner medical-writing rates from experienced professional rates and presents this as a longer-term opportunity rather than an instant source of income.

Getting started

Create several writing samples covering different healthcare subjects.

Then approach:

- Health websites
- Medical publishers
- Healthcare companies
- Hospitals
- Health startups
- Educational organizations

Best for: Nurses who prefer remote, independent work.

10. Health and Wellness Education

Nurses may also find opportunities in health education, depending on their credentials and local scope-of-practice rules.

Possible areas include general educational content around:

- Healthy habits
- Patient education
- Workplace wellness
- Health literacy
- Lifestyle education

The important distinction is between providing general education within your qualifications and making clinical diagnoses or treatment recommendations outside your legal scope.

Before offering any independent health-related service, check applicable professional regulations and insurance requirements.

Best for: Nurses interested in education rather than bedside care.

11. Resume and Interview Coaching for Nursing Students

Nurses who understand the hiring process can potentially help nursing students and newly qualified nurses prepare for employment.

Services could include:

- Resume reviews
- Interview practice
- Job-search guidance
- Professional communication
- Mock interviews
- Cover-letter feedback

This can be performed remotely using video calls or document-based services.

The advantage is that appointments can be short and scheduled around your existing shifts.

This is particularly suitable for experienced nurses who have spent years working in healthcare and understand what employers commonly look for.

Best for: Experienced nurses who enjoy mentoring.

12. Healthcare Content Creation

Social media can also become a long-term side business.

Nurses can create educational content around topics they are qualified to discuss, such as:

- Nursing school
- Study tips
- Career advice
- General healthcare education
- Professional development
- Workplace experiences

Possible monetization methods can include advertising, sponsorships, affiliate marketing, digital products, memberships, or educational services.

However, content creation should be considered a long-term project rather than guaranteed quick income.

It can take months to develop an audience.

You should also be careful with patient privacy and never disclose confidential patient information.

Side Hustles for Nurses Compared

Side Hustle	Main Benefit	Startup Requirement	Flexibi
Per Diem/PRN Nursing	Direct nursing income	Active license	High
Telehealth	Remote clinical work	License + experience	High
Medical Surveys	Very low commitment	Professional profile	Very hi
Vaccine Clinics	Short seasonal shifts	Relevant credentials	High
Clinical Research	Structured work	Nursing experience	Mediu

Side Hustle	Main Benefit	Startup Requirement	Flexibi
Legal Nurse Consulting	Specialized professional work	Clinical experience	High
CPR/BLS/ACLS Training	Teaching income	Instructor qualification	High
NCLEX Tutoring	Uses existing knowledge	Subject expertise	Very hi
Medical Writing	Remote freelance work	Writing ability	Very hi
Health Education	Knowledge-based work	Appropriate credentials	High
Resume Coaching	Mentoring	Nursing experience	Very hi
Content Creation	Long-term scalability	Content skills	Very hi

How to Choose the Right Nurse Side Hustle

There is no universal answer to which side hustle is right for every nurse.

Instead, start with your primary goal.

If you need money quickly

Per diem or PRN nursing shifts may be more practical because they directly use an existing professional qualification.

If you want to work from home

Telehealth, medical writing, tutoring, consulting, and certain research roles may provide remote possibilities.

If you only have a few free hours

Medical surveys, tutoring, writing, or short appointments may fit better than another 12-hour shift.

If you want to build a business

Legal nurse consulting, medical writing, tutoring, coaching, or content creation can potentially grow beyond individual shifts.

If you enjoy teaching

CPR instruction, nursing tutoring and health education may be worth exploring.

How to Start a Nursing Side Hustle

Starting a side business does not mean you have to immediately commit to dozens of hours.

A smaller test can tell you whether the idea fits your life.

Step 1: Check your employer's rules

Your hospital or healthcare employer may have policies covering moonlighting, outside employment, conflicts of interest, or working for competing organizations.

Review those rules before accepting additional clinical work.

Step 2: Confirm your license and credentials

Make sure your nursing license and any certifications required for the side job are current.

Do not accept work that goes beyond your legal scope of practice.

Step 3: Calculate your actual earnings

An advertised hourly rate does not necessarily equal your take-home income.

Consider:

- Taxes
- Transportation
- Platform fees
- Insurance
- Equipment
- Training costs
- Unpaid administrative time

Step 4: Start with a manageable workload

Your first goal should be testing the business model.

One client, one weekly tutoring session, or one extra shift can tell you a lot.

Step 5: Track everything

Keep records of income and legitimate business expenses.

If you are working independently or as a contractor, understand the tax obligations that apply to your situation.

Side Hustles for Nurses and Work-Life Balance

One of the biggest mistakes nurses can make is treating every day off as another potential workday.

Nursing can be physically and mentally demanding.

If you work several long shifts and immediately fill every day away from the hospital with additional work, your recovery time can disappear.

A better approach is to protect your essential personal time first.

For example:

Work → Recover → Side hustle → Personal time

can be more sustainable than:

Work → Side hustle → Side hustle → Work

Your side income should support your financial goals without creating an unsustainable schedule.

The source article also emphasizes matching the side hustle to the nurse's actual rotation and protecting sleep rather than simply maximizing available hours.

Side Hustle Mistakes Nurses Should Avoid

Not every opportunity marketed to nurses is worth pursuing.

Avoid guaranteed-income claims

No legitimate course or platform can guarantee that you will make a specific amount of money.

Be careful with upfront fees

Research any company that asks you to pay before providing work.

Do not ignore licensing rules

A nursing license does not automatically authorize every healthcare service.

Do not confuse gross revenue with profit

If you make $1,000 from a side business but spend $300 on expenses and owe taxes, you did not actually keep $1,000.

Protect patient privacy

Never use confidential patient information to create content, marketing materials, case studies, or social media posts without proper authorization.

Do not sacrifice sleep

Extra income is not worth creating an unsafe work schedule.

Can Nurses Make $1,000 a Month From a Side Hustle?

It is possible for some nurses to generate $1,000 or more in additional monthly income, but the actual amount varies substantially.

The result depends on:

- Nursing specialty
- Location
- Hourly rate
- Number of shifts
- Client demand
- Side-business expenses

- Available time
- Experience
- Professional credentials

Someone picking up occasional shifts may have a very different result from someone operating a full consulting or tutoring business.

Rather than focusing only on a monthly target, calculate how many hours you are willing to work and what net income you need from those hours.

Can Nurses Make Money Without Working Another Nursing Shift?

Yes.

A nursing license can open doors to several non-bedside opportunities.

Medical writing, tutoring, consulting, research, education and content creation can all potentially use nursing knowledge without requiring another traditional bedside shift.

This can be particularly useful for nurses who want additional income but are trying to reduce physical workload.

Final Thoughts on Side Hustles for Nurses

The best side hustle for nurses is not necessarily the one with the highest advertised hourly rate.

It is the option that fits your qualifications, schedule, energy level, financial goals and professional responsibilities.

Per diem and PRN shifts can provide a straightforward way to monetize an existing license. Telehealth can offer remote flexibility. Tutoring and CPR instruction can turn knowledge into teaching income. Medical writing can create a longer-term freelance career. Legal nurse consulting and clinical research can provide more specialized professional opportunities.

You also do not have to choose only one.

A nurse might combine an occasional PRN shift with tutoring, writing, or another flexible activity.

Start small, calculate the real financial return, protect your recovery time, and make sure every service you provide stays within your qualifications and applicable rules.

With the right approach, your days away from the hospital can become an opportunity to build extra income for nurses without turning your entire life into another full-time job.

Frequently Asked Questions

What are the best side hustles for nurses in 2026?

Popular options include per diem nursing, PRN shifts, telehealth, medical surveys, clinical research, legal nurse consulting, CPR instruction, NCLEX tutoring and medical writing. The right option depends on your experience, schedule and qualifications.

What is the easiest side hustle for a nurse to start?

For a nurse with an active license, picking up a suitable PRN or per diem shift may require less new training than starting a completely different business. The exact onboarding requirements vary by employer.

Can nurses make extra money from home?

Yes. Telehealth, medical writing, nursing tutoring, legal nurse consulting and some educational or content-based businesses can potentially be performed remotely.

Can nurses have a second job?

Many nurses can work additional jobs, but employer policies vary. Check your organization's rules regarding outside employment, scheduling, conflicts of interest and maximum working hours.

What side hustle is best for a nurse with a busy schedule?

Flexible options such as tutoring, medical surveys, writing and selected per-diem shifts can be easier to fit around a demanding schedule because they do not necessarily require a fixed second job every day.

Do nurses need another certification for a side hustle?

Not always. Some opportunities use your existing nursing license and experience. Others, such as specific instructor roles, may require additional training or credentials.

Is legal nurse consulting a good side business?

Legal nurse consulting can be a specialized opportunity for experienced nurses, but it generally takes time to build professional relationships and a client base. It should be treated as a business that requires preparation rather than instant income.

Can nurses make money tutoring nursing students?

Yes. Nurses can potentially tutor students in subjects such as pharmacology, dosage calculations, nursing fundamentals and NCLEX preparation, depending on their expertise.

How much can a nurse make from a side hustle?

There is no fixed amount. Income depends on the type of side hustle, location, experience, hours worked, client demand and operating expenses. Advertised gross rates should not be confused with take-home income.

How can nurses start a side hustle without burning out?

Start with a small workload and protect sleep and personal time. Choose flexible work rather than automatically adding another full-time schedule. Your side hustle should fit around your primary career rather than undermine it.